DIMA ALAZZI

Experience Research Lead | Wealth & Financial Services

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Experienced research leader with 10+ years shaping evidence-led decisions across wealth, digital products and complex services, across different sectors and markets. At Barclays, I own the research roadmap for Wealth Planning & Advice and Digital Investing, translating client and advisor needs into product, proposition and business direction. I bring hands-on experience applying AI-enabled approaches to research and decision-making, combining applied AI/ML training, generative AI adoption initiatives, agentic workflow automation and a track record of building trusted research capability in regulated, high-stakes environments

Areas of focus: Research strategy • AI-enabled research • Product discovery and evaluation • Research operations • Governance and standards • Stakeholder influence • Wealth and advisor journeys

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Barclays | AVP, Senior Design Researcher, Wealth Management (AI Capabilities for Insights)

London, UK | Oct 2024 - Present

- Own the strategic research roadmap for Planning & Advice and Digital Investing,
- Shape customer and advisor propositions across retirement, pensions, SIPP, ISA and targeted support experiences
- Bring client and advisor evidence into senior decision-making, partnering across proposition, product, design, compliance and delivery
- Selected as the team's first Copilot Champion, leading adoption of AI-assisted research workflows, piloting automation opportunities and training colleagues in agent development and automation
- Manage external research agencies and manage research prioritization and capability development

Sky (Comcast Group) | Senior UX Researcher, Connected Entertainment

London, UK | Sep 2021 - Sep 2024

- Led discovery and evaluative research for flagship connected-entertainment products in the UK, US, Italy and Germany
- Delivered behavioural frameworks that aligned senior stakeholders on priority needs and trade-offs.
- Participated in a Google Gen AI/ LLM hackathon with Sky Labs and contributed to the internal guidance on responsible use of generative AI in research

BBC | Senior Research Manager, Data & Digital

London, UK | Apr 2020 - Sep 2021

- Led research across Ethiopia, Sierra Leone and Bangladesh, training local researchers and setting shared ethics and quality standards during COVID.
- Conceived and secured approval for a multilingual conversational AI chatbot with analysis dahsbaord, translation APIs and a central insight repository
- Secured funding by repositioning it as the programme's long-term evidence repository; led discovery, specification, tendering and early delivery.

Mencap | Impact & Evaluation Manager

London, UK | Sep 2016 - Mar 2020

- Built and line-managed a three-person research and evaluation team, from hiring and capability development to portfolio planning and quality standards.
- Led mixed-methods research that informed national service design and operational decisions for senior leaders.

Moovr | Co-Founder, Product & Research

Kenya & United Kingdom | Aug 2016 - Dec 2018

- Co-founded a livestock logistics venture for rural Kenya (Uber for Cows); won the Allesch-Taylor Grant to fund field validation.
- Led a month-long field study- interviews, contextual inquiry and focus groups- with farmers and truck drivers. Set ground for partnerships with Safaricom, Kenya Livestock Marketing Council and Oxfam.
- Converted findings into a WhatsApp and M-Pesa MVP; secured two letters of intent for a pilot.
- Nominated by King's Entrepreneurship Institute to attend Queen Elizabeth II's Royal Garden Party at Buckingham Palace.

United Nations (IOM) | Research & Monitoring Associate

Damascus, Syria | Dec 2013 - Sep 2015

- Conducted in-person interviews and rapid impact assessments with displaced communities during the Syrian conflict, reporting to donors including FCDO, ECHO and CIDA to inform emergency response and livelihoods programming.

Syriatel Mobile Telecom | Quality Management Specialist

Damascus, Syria | Apr 2011 - Sep 2012

- Implemented ISO-aligned quality and process frameworks, strengthening audit readiness, service consistency and continuous improvement.

EDUCATION

- **Cambridge Spark | Certificate in Data Science, Machine Learning and Applied AI, 2019**
  - 10-month applied programme in Python, data science, and ML/AI . Worked on Capstone projects: building an NLP model (spaCy, Prodigy) at Cytora- AI Insurance company- to extract data from broker documents; presented to Cambridge academics and financial-services leaders, including Morgan Stanley.
- King's College London | King's Entrepreneurship Institute Accelerator, 2016- 2017
- King's College London | MSc Economics and Business | Chevening Award Scholar | **2:1,** 2015-2017
- Damascus University | BSc Economics and Business | First Class Honours **1:1,** 2006-2010

SKILLS

AI and Agentic Practice: Applied AI and machine learning fundamentals, NLP model-building (spaCy, Prodigy), generative AI adoption (Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT, Google Gemini), agentic workflow automation (Power Automate), responsible and ethical AI adoption

Research Methods: Generative and evaluative research, usability testing, contextual inquiry, surveys, journey mapping, facilitation, research governance and ethics

Tools: Qualtrics, Maze, Python, SharePoint, Power Automate

Credential: Risk & Control Accreditation **Languages:** English (fluent), Arabic (native)